

ST. MICHAEL FIRST VILLAGE

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The original ten were easy, and finally I persuaded five more, three ladies and two men. A party of eight from Los Angeles I could not move. They had tickets for the inside passage and they were going to make it, if they had to stay in St. Michael until the last boat. I turned in the 15 tickets and the agent said he would wireless Nome and would get a reply at eight o'clock.

Then a waiter on our boat, an Austrian, who I had given a few tips, came to me with the confidential advice to "save my bloody legs." He said the navigation company and the hotel played the game together, that our stay in the town meant \$200 a day to the hotel and the boat would never return. He had the right dope.

Then I went down to the wharf and under the lament of the former sufferer, I wrote—

"My God! Eight DAYS more." And later on I changed it to 12 days—for that was our sentence. And days before the boat went out that party of eight went into self-scourging because they had refused to change their route. A lady had found a worm on her lettuce.

While the two weeks in St. Michael were tedious and one grew very impatient at times, yet this oldest of Alaskan towns was wonderfully full of stories, and I think the time passed more quickly with me than with any other passenger, and during the 12 days' exile I gained 12 pounds in weight.

St. Michael was, I believe, the first settlement in Western Alaska—many, many years before there was ever a white man at Nome, and many years before we purchased it from Russia. It was the first town between White Horse and Nome, 2100 miles, that was not built of logs, although there are a few of the ancient log buildings of the Russians yet standing in splendid preservation—one of which was being remodelled for a school for white children. And it was very interesting to me to note the way those log houses were built, as the workers sawed through the logs for windows for the school house.

Each log was grooved, hollowed out, so that it would seat over the log under, and before the log was fitted, dry moss was laid between. This made a very warm building.

There is no timber along the lower Yukon, and St. Michael is built of lumber, all shipped in from the outside, and you may be sure no unnecessary buildings were erected, or any waste room in the houses. All the fuel, soft coal in sacks, has to be shipped in from the states. The army posts had just received 9000 sacks and the soldiers were busy unloading it.

The first place of interest that got me was a Russian fort, not a dozen rods from the hotel. It was octagonal in shape, about 10 feet across, built of heavy logs, and with a roof running to a peak. Inside, rusting away, are seven old Russian cannons, curious, low guns, with solid iron wheels, and the barrels fastened to the standards with ropes. All around the blockhouse are holes, with barred doors for the use of the cannons, and above them long slits, about three inches wide, for the use of the small arms. They told me this block house was built in 1700.

On the main street of the town is another old Russian building, now used for a repair shop, and over the door a copper tablet, "Built by the Russian Fur Co. in 1833."

After I had looked over the ancient Russian fort I walked up to the army post, with its modern buildings, and I concluded we had made some progress in Alaska since Czar Peter went into the real estate business.

St. Michael is some busy during the short summer season. This is the point where incoming ocean ships transfer their freight to the up-river boats and where the down-river transfer their passengers. Very little freight goes out of Alaska.

There is a big force of longshoremen at St. Michael. They work 15 hours a day and get 50 cents an hour, seven days in a week, while at Nome, 110 miles across the bay, the wage scale is one dollar per hour.

But it is only during the summer season that the yeast works in St. Michael. When the winter sets in, ocean navigation closes and the Yukon freezes to a depth of four feet, then the town imitates the hibernation.

When the last boat goes out, it blows its whistle for a full half hour in wailing long-drawn-out wails, while the lonesome, heartick people who remain in, stand on the shore and watch it depart. And then for a week there is one grand drunk. Everybody goes to it. You cannot get waited on in the stores. All are trying to drown their sorrow. And this condition is true of every river town on the Yukon.

St. Michael is trimmed with desolation—former greatness. On one side of the town are six steamboats, drawn up on the bank and rotting down. In the bay on the other side are seven river steamers, all seaworthy, pulled up on skids and idle. These represent hundreds of thousands of dollars. These abandoned boats give one the feeling that he is looking at a cemetery. They are the monuments of former life. "Alaska is dying," said a tourist as we stood on a point and looked down on the village.

The army post was built for a large garrison, but the soldiers are not there now, only 40 remain, and I don't know why they are kept. Many of the buildings are vacant now, and the post is in keeping with the rest of the surroundings.

I sat on the hill near the wireless station, looking down on the town, with my chin in my hands. An Eskimo came along, looked at me and asked, "Trouble?" I nodded "yes."

"Got launch?" he asked. "No," I replied. "Got fish wheel?" Again I shook my head. "Got squaw?" "No," I again answered. Then he smiled and said, "You got no trouble."

Trouble, to an Eskimo's understanding, is embraced in these three, a launch, a fishwheel and a squaw. There is a Russian church at St. Michael, and I found a Russian who got a key and let us in. It is peculiar from the fact there are no seats in it, the congregation remaining standing during the services. No services are held now and the Russian sadly stated no more would ever be held. The Russian government supported the church and paid the priest, but the new government cut off all such appropriations, and the church will now become one more of the old town's historic places.

One of the four stores in the town believes in advertising. Its display ad. is a big black bear which I was told has been chained there for 20 years. The tourists buy bottles of pop for bruin, when he will climb to a platform on top of a pole, sit down like a man and empty the bottle.

Through the store windows of an old abandoned trading store I saw the great ivory tusks of a mastodon, among the debris of the floor. In this part of Alaska, and particularly around Marshall, further up the river, the finding of mastodon skeletons is not at all unusual, in fact it is common. Miners often, very often, strike them in digging prospect holes. In the centuries ago these pre-historic creatures roamed the hills and valleys. In those ages Alaska was not the country of ice it is now. The season changed and the mastodon and many other animals disappeared and have been buried by the accumulation of untold centuries. The wolverine is said to be the only pre-historic animal of the north country to survive.

Eighteen miles outside of St. Michael is a reindeer ranch, and a party of us visited it one Sunday. A giant Eskimo squaw is the proprietress. She had about 1200 in the bunch, and they are herded like sheep. She raises them both for meat and for teams. Dressed they weigh about 150 pounds and the skins find a ready market with the natives from which to make parkas. The bucks are worth about \$22 apiece for meat, but the does come higher, in fact it is difficult to buy them. They are valued for breeding purposes. Hundreds of these deer are butchered and taken aboard the steamers.

Reindeer raising bids fair to become a profitable business on the lower river, and the white men are beginning to realize it. It is said 94 per cent increase can be depended on, and the expense is very small. The range is free to anyone. The deer live on leaves and brush in the summer time and on moss in the winter.

An ocean freighter came into the harbor with a load of steel rails for the government railroad a thousand miles up the river, at Nenana, near Fairbanks. The big boats cannot come into the shallow water at St. Michael. They anchor out and unload onto barges. I sat on a point nearest to the freighter and watched the big crane pick up the rails and lay them on the barge. The barge was nearly loaded, when a rail, suspended high above the barge, slipped from the tackle and fell end first onto the scow. It went completely through it and before anything could be done the barge sank to the ocean bottom with 440 tons of rails.

And the government officials at Nenana will wait some time for the railroad iron. Before an electric magnet can be brought from Seattle the winter will have closed its grip on the Yukon.

In the next letter I am going to tell you something about the Eskimos. There is a village of them in St. Michael. I spent many hours observing them and I have had many talks with some of the more intelligent English-speaking ones.

ONE MILL IMPROVES; OTHER IMPROVES

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for the trip, as a "lark."

The first violence attendant upon the strike occurred Friday evening at 5 o'clock, when F. W. Larson, a special policeman paid by the Hawley Pulp & Paper company, attempted to take to jail Chief of Police Lee French, suffering, in consequence, the indignity of being thrown into jail himself and having his face badly battered by strikers. According to all accounts of the trouble Chief French was making an effort to clear the passage over the bridge, where strikers had gathered to greet strikebreakers from the Crown-Willamette mills. Larson interfered with the group and started toward the jail with French.

The special officer drew his "billy," it is said, after the chief of police had shown his star, and French charges him with resisting. Strikers following in the crowd that had assembled took Larson's revolver and club. Several of them struck Larson. Larson came to Oregon City from Portland and was sworn in as a special officer by Mayor E. C. Hackett. The special officers are paid by the company, and the chief of police says he had been instructed by the company to work under him, but that their territory was confined to the mill property.

A demonstration threatened again that night when Mayor Hackett released Larson from jail and restored him to his duties, with instructions, however, to remain away from the bridge. Strikers objected vainly to the man's release.

Mayor E. C. Hackett on Saturday relieved from service all special policemen he had appointed to guard the mills. This action was taken at the request of officials of the striking unions, who have promised to

see to the strict maintenance of order. The union men believe they can prevent a recurrence of the trouble of Friday evening. Mayor Hackett expressed his willingness to relieve the special police, but told the union men that it would be necessary for the city to take the reins again if trouble was started.

SCHOOL ORGANIZED

Mildred Atkins is Superintendent of Sandy Sabbath Classes

Sandy Sunday school has been organized with Miss Mildred Atkins as superintendent. The other officers selected are Mrs. A. C. Baumback, assistant superintendent; Mrs. R. E. Smith, secretary and treasurer; Mrs. R. E. Eason, organist; H. H. Watkins, bible class teachers; Miss Atkins, senior girls; James Brehaut, senior boys; Robert Smith, junior boys; Mrs. Bauback, primary. Sunday school is held at 10:30 a. m. Sundays, and Young People's meeting at 7 p. m. Mrs. R. E. Eason will be the leader next Sunday evening.

Cut This Out—It is Worth Money

DON'T MISS THIS. Cut out this slip, enclose with 5c and mail it to Foley — Co., 2835 Sheffield Ave., Chicago, Ill., writing your name and address clearly. You will receive in return a trial package containing Foley's Honey and Tar Compound, for coughs, colds, and croup; Foley Kidney Pills, for pain in sides and back, rheumatism, lumbago, kidney and bladder ailments; and Foley Cathartic Tablets, a wholesome and thoroughly cleansing cathartic for constipation, biliousness, headache and sluggish bowels.—Jones Drug Co.

Telford Asks Citizenship

Alexander Telford, of Oak Grove, would become a full-fledged American citizen through a petition for final citizenship filed in County Clerk Harrington's office here Friday. Telford is a native of Ireland and has lived in America for many years.

The Courier and Oregon Farmer, both for \$1.00.

The Brunswick

All Phonographs in One

HAVE YOU MADE THE LIVES OF YOUR CHILDREN COMPLETE?

THE influence of music in the home is not a thing to be taken lightly. What child—or grown person for that matter—is not better for an appreciation of good music?

The Brunswick offers the ENTIRE REPERTOIRE of the world's greatest musicians—IT PLAYS ALL RECORDS. There are no limitations upon the music you can have in your home.

The clear, vibrant voice that comes from THE BRUNSWICK will give your children a greater liking for musical art.

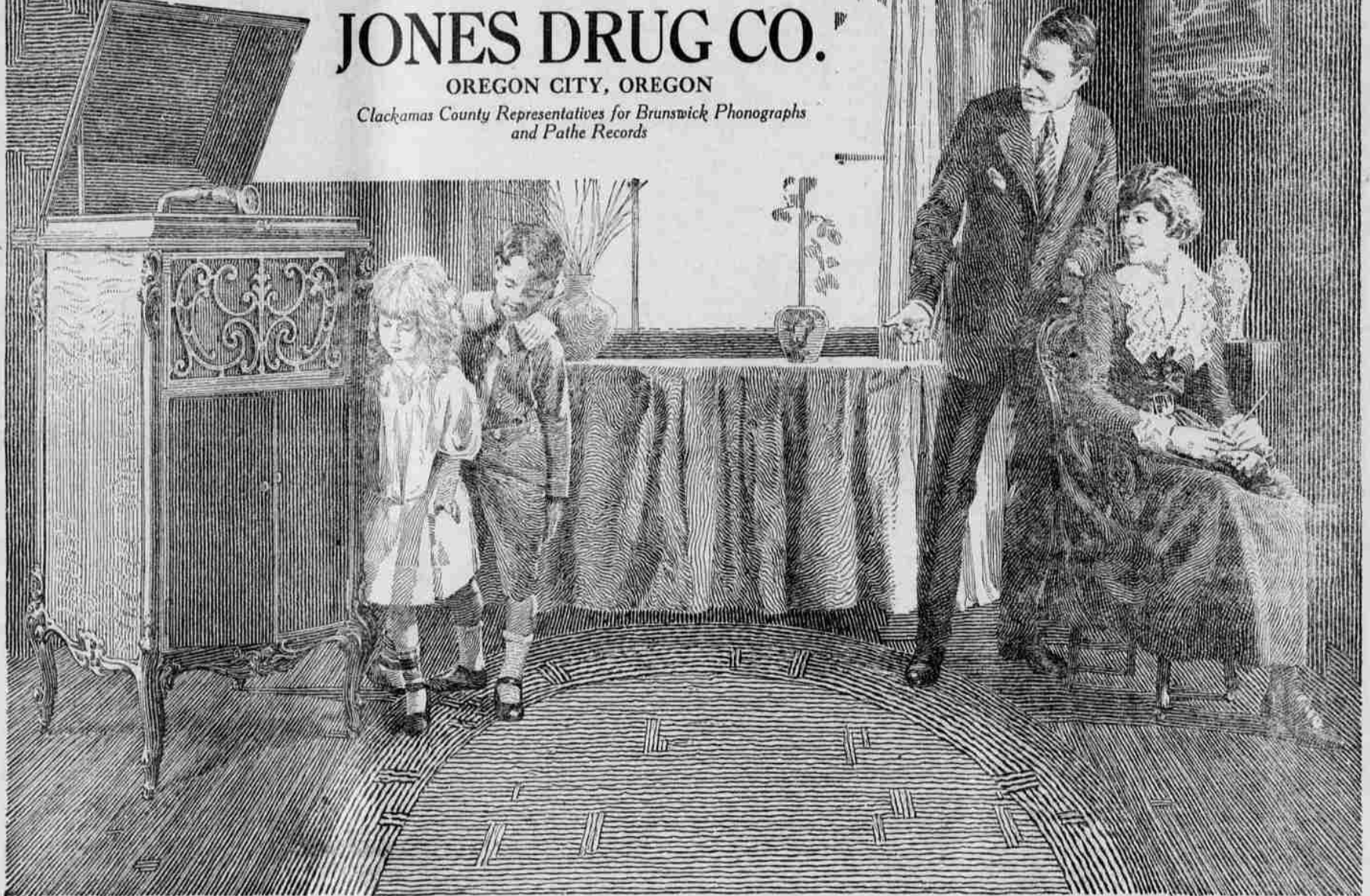
THE BRUNSWICK is designed and built by the House of Brunswick, for 76 years a leader in wood working. It is furnished in ten models—priced from \$30 to \$1500.

COMPARE IT WITH OTHERS BEFORE YOU BUY
"ALL PHONOGRAPHS IN ONE"

JONES DRUG CO.

OREGON CITY, OREGON

Clackamas County Representatives for Brunswick Phonographs and Pathe Records



Sloan's Liniment

KILLS PAIN

YOKES OF MATRIMONY YANKED OFF IN COURT

Wearied of the yoke of matrimony six wives have sought relief this week through the popular channel of Judge Campbell's divorce mill, and in proportion to the grist that has gone into the mill couples with the holy bonds yanked off have been turned out to go the way of freedom.

The prize for the week goes to Mildred and Thomas Saylor, who unfortunately went to Vancouver to tie the knot less than four weeks ago today. They were married on October 22. Mrs. Saylor, in a complaint filed Wednesday, charges her husband with infidelity, cruelty and non-support. Less than a week after the wedding Saylor associated with an "old sweetheart" and when his wife remonstrated with him he told her to "forget it," and announced that the old love was best. She wants to resume her maiden name, Mildred Worrell.

Nellie Underwood on Tuesday brought suit against Paul Underwood to whom she was married at Aberdeen, Wash., on December 12, 1901. That gentleman rudely deserted his loving spouse, the complaint charges, in June 1902. Mrs. Underwood wants the court to restore her maiden name, Nellie Wetherwax.

Maxine Sandberg charges Alfred Sandberg with cruelty in a complaint filed Monday. The couple was married at Portland on January 13, 1911 and Mrs. Sandberg wants her maiden name, Maxine Walker, restored to her.

Grace C. Girt asks a divorce

from James E. Girt, to whom she was married at Vancouver, Wash., on January 8, 1911. She charges cruelty and asks for a division of real and personal property valued at \$5100, in which is included 600 jars of fruit which she canned. The real property includes 10 acres of land in this county. Mrs. Girt charges that her husband smoked incessantly and would not permit her to open the windows in the low-ceiled rooms in which they lived. She asks \$25 a month alimony.

Margaret Kerns Thursday filed a complaint against G. D. Kerns, to whom she was married at Vancouver, Wash., on December 24, 1913, charging cruelty. She alleges that her husband at one time drew a gun and threatened to kill her. Mrs. Kerns asks the restoration of her maiden name, Margaret Murray.

Hesta Forrest, married to Robert D. Forrest, at Portland, on January 25, 1912, Friday filed suit for divorce, making cruelty the principal charge. Mrs. Forrest asks for the custody of their two-year-old daughter and \$20 a month alimony.

Judge J. U. Campbell last Thursday signed a decree divorcing Mary and Clarence Nye and restoring to Mrs. Nye her maiden name, Mary Wenker. The complaint filed by Dossa A. Wilcoxon against Joseph L. Wilcoxon was dismissed Wednesday after the couple had "made up" and promised to "live happily ever after."

CLACKAMAS REPORT SAID TO BE GREATLY SPOTTED

While no county organization of the state has yet completed its returns on the two weeks' canvass for enrollment of families in the national food administration, reports which are approaching final totals are now fast coming into the office of Chairman Arthur M. Churchill, director of the state drive. The returns vary from highly gratifying figures, exceeding all expectations, to figures that leave much to be desired, the director said Monday.

Latest compilations showed these county totals: Baker, 2165, Clackamas, 2562, Coos, 1700, Douglas 3332,

Gilliam 618, Jackson, 4071, Josephine 1700, Morrow 926, Union 2650, Wasco, 2636. Few of the county chairmen have accompanied their reports with figures on slacker families.

Completion of returns from 48 districts in Douglas county is awaited. The Riddle district signed up 72 families without encountering a refusal. Wasco county is said to be nearer the 100 per cent record at present than any other of the state. Preliminary returns and messages from Lane and Marion lead Mr. Churchill to expect fine showings from them.

Clackamas county workers have returned one of the most "spotted" and unsatisfactory preliminary reports yet to reach headquarters. While seven districts enrolled every home and others achieved records above 90 per cent, a number fell below 60 per cent.

BLANCHARD AND WILSON MENTIONED IN STORIES

David Hazen, writing from Camp Mills to the Portland Telegram, furnishes the following interesting notes about Oregon City soldiers:

"It might be well to tell of the adventure that befell two of company G's lieutenants on their way to this station. Their train passed through a famous fish city and they thought it the best opportunity of their young lives to secure a mess of fresh oysters right from the oyster factory. At other cities of any size the train had been stopped from 30 to 50 minutes, taking water and having bearings examined, so Lieutenant Edward E. "Tuffy" Walker and Lieutenant Eldon C. Blanchard decided to have their oyster banquet and get back to the "kivvered cars" within half an hour.

But there happened to be a hurry-up conductor in charge and only a three minute stop was made. The officers enjoyed the feast, returned to the depot, said many strange words and took a fast train for a city some distance away. Here they waited, keeping out of sight when the first section of their train passed through. They caught their own command seven hours

after leaving it. These lieutenants, along with every other officer in the Beaver contingent, have been making friends with the officers of the regiment across the Columbia. The Evergreen officers and the good fellows who live south of them in peace times have enjoyed many a bumper of loganberry juice together, said juice being direct from the manufacturers at Salem.

Another item regarding newspapers says: "Now that one Oregon paper has been mentioned, it might be well to state that Sergeant Kent Wilson, of Oregon City, a member of the medical corps of the machine gun company, receives each day, save Sunday, a copy of The Dalles Chronicle. Sergeant Wilson was stationed at the Wasco county capital last summer, and while there met a most delightful newspaper person, who forwards the paper to him wherever he may roam."

WRITERS NOTICE!

The Courier desires the services of a capable correspondent at Boring. Several other communities in the county are not represented. Anyone interested is invited to communicate with this office. It may be to YOUR advantage.

Orena May Selected

Orena May, a popular young business woman, is one of the first in Clackamas county to respond to the government's call for stenographers and Tuesday evening received a telegram from Adjutant General McClain announcing her selection for a position in the adjutant general's office at Washington paying \$1100. Miss May passed the civil service test with a high rating, but has decided not to go to Washington.

To win the war we must save food in every household, and at every meal, and in this work the housewives of America are an army with banners.